

PRODUCT LAUNCH DOSSIER / 2026

Northstar Atlas

A field-ready observability platform for teams that need one calm view of every service, signal, and decision.

Prepared by the Atlas launch office for the executive steering group. This document

combines product narrative, readiness evidence, operating assumptions, and the release decision record.

Launch candidate

Controlled rollout

REV 04 · APPROVED



96.8%

pilot task completion

41 ms

median event-to-view

18 / 20

readiness gates passed

Decision brief

Atlas is ready for a staged launch to the first six design partners. The remaining gates are operational rather than architectural: customer support rotation, the final export-control review, and a documented rollback rehearsal.

The release is intentionally bounded. New tenants receive a stable ingestion contract, role-based views, auditable annotations, and a small set of integrations. Advanced anomaly training remains behind an experiment flag.

Decision requested: approve the 2026-09-14 controlled rollout, with a 48-hour hold after each cohort.

Inside this dossier

- 1. [Market and product story](#)
- 2. [Readiness scorecard](#)
- 3. [Architecture appendix](#)
- 4. [Release decision record](#)

Owner: Priya Nair · Atlas Launch Office
Classification: internal planning material

W32

Pilot close

W35

Support rehearsal

W37

Wave one

W39

Review gate

WHY NOW

From alert volume to operating clarity

Modern service teams do not lack telemetry; they lack a shared shape for interpreting it. Logs, traces, tickets, and ownership data arrive in different languages, leaving incident commanders to assemble a temporary narrative under pressure.

Atlas turns those fragments into a reviewable operating picture. A signal can be connected to a service, a service to a team, and a decision to the evidence that justified it. The product

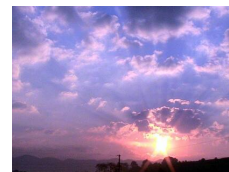


Fig. 2.1 — Atlas event map thumbnail.

is useful when the room is busy because the context is already attached.

"The value is not another graph. It is the five minutes we get back when everyone sees the same graph and the same next action."

— Pilot participant, platform reliability lead

Observe

Normalize events into a compact service timeline with provenance, severity, and retention controls.

Core

Explain

Attach deploys, ownership, runbooks, and annotations directly to the evidence under review.

Core

Coordinate

Give incident roles a shared handoff board without forcing every participant into the same workflow.

Pilot

Learn

Turn the final timeline into a durable review record and a small set of measurable follow-ups.

Later

Positioning principle

Atlas is a coordination surface, not a replacement for source-of-truth monitoring systems. It links evidence and decisions while leaving collection and alert evaluation with the systems that already own them.

Risk boundary: Atlas must never imply that an unavailable integration has produced a clean result. Empty, delayed, and disconnected states are shown distinctly in the product and in the export.

Audience and adoption signals

Platform leads. They want a service map that reflects how teams actually operate, including temporary ownership during an incident. Their strongest request was a fast path from a symptom to the responsible runbook.

Incident commanders. They value a narrow, printable summary at the end of a shift. The summary needs a timeline, decisions, unresolved questions, and explicit owners, not a screenshot wall.

Adoption hypothesis. Teams will retain the workflow when the first useful view appears within one minute, the first annotation takes fewer than three clicks, and exports can be shared without granting broad workspace access.

Engineering managers. They need recurring patterns without turning every review into a performance ranking. Atlas separates learning signals from individual blame and keeps the evidence visible.

EVIDENCE REVIEW

Launch readiness is high, with two explicit holds

The scorecard below is deliberately granular. A green row means the evidence is complete for this launch cohort; an amber row means the owner and exit condition are known; a coral row is a stop condition.

ID	Capability	Evidence	Owner	State	Exit
R-01	Tenant isolation	Cross-tenant integration suite, 184 cases	Security	Pass	closed
R-02	Event ingestion backpressure	Three-hour replay at 4× pilot peak	Runtime	Pass	closed
R-03	Export and redaction	PII fixture corpus, PDF and JSON snapshots	Trust	Hold	2026-09-04
R-04	Role-based access	Admin, commander, reader matrix	Identity	Pass	closed
R-05	Support rotation	On-call rehearsal with 12 scripted cases	Operations	Hold	2026-09-08
R-06	Rollback rehearsal	Restore from versioned snapshot under load	Runtime	Pass	closed
R-07	Audit retention	90-day retention and legal hold simulation	Trust	Pass	closed
R-08	Connector health states	Delayed, denied, empty, and stale fixtures	Product	Pass	closed
R-09	Mobile incident view	Responsive review at 320 px and 768 px	Experience	Hold	2026-09-11
R-10	Rate-limit messaging	Copy review plus load-test boundary	Runtime	Pass	closed
R-11	Data residency	Region routing and deletion evidence	Trust	Pass	closed
R-12	Partner enablement	Runbook, demo workspace, escalation tree	Growth	Pass	closed
R-13	Usage metering	Daily ledger reconciles within 0.1%	Finance	Pass	closed
R-14	Incident export	Print-safe summary with stable ordering	Experience	Pass	closed

Control interpretation

- Two holds are scheduled before cohort one; neither changes the ingestion contract.
- Any new coral state pauses expansion and triggers the rollback owner.
- Evidence links remain attached to the decision record for audit.

Controls assessed	14
Passed at review	11
Explicit holds	3
Stop conditions	0

Scorecard provenance: pilot run ATL-PILOT-06, support rehearsal RUN-12, and export review TR-44. Statuses are point-in-time and expire at the next release gate.

TECHNICAL SHAPE

Small contracts, observable boundaries

Collect

Adapters accept signed events and attach source, region, and arrival metadata.

Boundary: ingestion API

Shape

The normalizer maps source-specific fields into the Atlas event vocabulary.

Boundary: event model

Present

Views query a time-bounded projection and show missing context honestly.

Boundary: read model

Reference event contract

```
{
  "event_id": "evt_7f2a",
  "source": "deployments",
  "service": "checkout-api",
  "observed_at": "2026-08-18T14:20:00Z",
  "state": "degraded",
  "evidence": ["trace:8ab1", "deploy:331"],
  "visibility": "workspace"
}
```

Failure modes and responses

Condition	Shown to user	Action
Connector denied	Access required	Re-authorize source
Source delayed	Last update + age	Check connector health
Projection stale	Stale banner	Pause automated decision
No matching evidence	No evidence found	Broaden time window

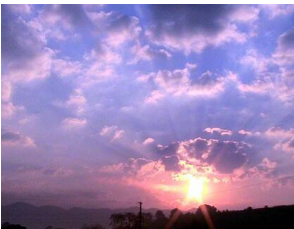
Implementation checklist

- ✓ Bound every query by tenant and region.
- ✓ Keep source timestamps separate from arrival time.
- ✓ Render unavailable integrations as a first-class state.
- ✓ Preserve evidence order in print and JSON exports.
- ✓ Emit correlation IDs in support diagnostics.

Deployment topology



Region A · primary



Region B · failover



Region C · archive

Design constraint: the read model may be eventually consistent, but it may not silently become authoritative. Every export carries its freshness timestamp and source coverage summary.

CLOSE THE LOOP

Controlled rollout authorization

The steering group authorizes a controlled rollout to six design partners beginning 2026-09-14. The launch office will review cohort health after 48 hours and may expand, hold, or roll back based on the gates below.

Required launch actions

- 1. Complete export redaction review and archive the fixture report.
- 2. Run the support rotation rehearsal with the named escalation owner.
- 3. Publish the customer-facing connector health glossary.
- 4. Record cohort-one decision notes before enabling cohort two.

Decision options

Option	Trigger	Consequence
Expand	All green; no severe support events	Open next cohort
Hold	Amber gate unresolved at review	Keep cohort size stable
Rollback	Data isolation or stale-state breach	Disable new writes

Approval record

Release train	Polaris / Atlas 1.0
Decision date	2026-08-21
Rollout start	2026-09-14, 09:00 UTC
Review window	48 hours per cohort
Rollback owner	Ravi Menon, Runtime
Record	ATL-DEC-2026-04 / readiness scorecard

Priya Nair

Launch office · prepared

Ravi Menon

Runtime · rollback owner

Elena Kovacs

Steering group · approved



Fig. 5.1 — Controlled rollout command view.

Current recommendation: expand after the two amber controls close. No coral stop condition is active.